Marketing Mix:

One of the key drivers in success for the Starbucks business has been the company's ability to harness its resources extremely effectively with respect to its marketing. The company has been extremely smart in utilizing all the marketing channels at its disposal (online, social media, retail, events) and to convince the public at large to spend money on buying Starbucks products. By gaining this goodwill, they succeeded in being a dominant player the American and Canadian coffee industry, with roughly a third of the total market share. Starbucks accomplished this feat by establishing a successful marketing mix of price, product, place and promotion and executing these to a specific standard, ensuring customers would return for their coffee and consider it a pleasant experience.

Product: Starbucks rose to dominance predominantly due to its vast array of premium quality product offerings. The company sells coffee, Italian-style espresso beverages, cold blended beverages, as well as a selection of premium teas. The company uses the public's perception of them as a premium quality brand as an advantage, promoting this notion to differentiation itself amongst the competition. For example, Starbucks vouches that it has the highest quality standards when it comes to their fresh brewed coffee. On the company website, Starbucks has a section dedicated to educating consumers as to how they source the best coffee beans, grown in optimal conditions enabling Starbucks to brew and sell what many consider premium coffee. Reasons include growing the beans at higher altitudes. According to the website, "the cold nights and warm days create denser beans. And denser beans have deeper, more complex flavors". The level of customization Starbucks offers its customers is almost unrivalled amongst its competition. The primary product focus for Starbucks is coffee, tea and giving it a competitive advantage amongst rivals such as Dukin Donuts in the US and Tim Hortons and McDonalds in Canada. Initiatives such as offering consumers a new and unique product for a limited duration, or hosting a secret menu online that customers can reference company offers a product available for a limited duration. Endeavors such as this justification as to why the product is extremely popular amongst millennials.

Promotion: how manage their product through the distribution chain for them to sell premium coffee. Starbucks also promotes that they employs ethical labor practice for all beans grown through its farmers.